

**UNIT
4**

**ACTIVE VOICE
AND
PASSIVE VOICE**

UNIT 4 ACTIVE VOICE AND PASSIVE VOICE

Active voice & Passive voice rules chart

Tense	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Present Indefinite	Do/does	Is/am/are + by (agent)
Present Continuous	Is/am/are	Is/am/are + being + by (agent)
Present Perfect	Has/have	Has been/have been + by (agent)
Past Indefinite	Did	Was/were + by (agent)
Past Continuous	Was/were	Was/were + being + by (agent)
Past Perfect	Had	Had been + by (agent)
Future Indefinite	Will	Will be + by (agent)
Future Perfect	Will have	Will have been + by (agent)

Tense	Active Voice Structure	Passive Voice Structure	Example Active	Example Passive
Present Simple	Subject + base verb (s/es) + Object	Subject + is/are/am + past participle	She writes a letter.	A letter is written by her.
Present Continuous	Subject + is/are + verb-ing	Subject + is/are/am + being + past participle	They are playing football.	Football is being played by them.
Present Perfect	Subject + has/have + past participle	Subject + has/have + been + past participle	He has finished his homework.	His homework has been finished by him.
Past Simple	Subject + past verb	Subject + was/were + past participle	She made a cake.	A cake was made by her.
Past Continuous	Subject + was/were + verb-ing	Subject + was/were + being + past participle	I was reading a book.	A book was being read by me.
Past Perfect	Subject + had + past participle	Subject + had + been + past participle	They had completed the task.	The task had been completed by them.
Future Simple	Subject + will + base verb	Subject + will + be + past participle	He will write a letter.	A letter will be written by him.
Future Perfect	Subject + will + have + past participle	Subject + will + have + been + past participle	He will have completed the work.	The work will have been completed by him.

Passive Voice

Passive voice in English is used when the focus is on the action or the recipient of the action, not the doer. Passive constructions are formed by placing the object of the active sentence as the subject of the passive sentence. **We form the passive with the verb to be and the past participle of the main verb.**

Examples:

- **Active:** The gardener plants the flowers.
- **Passive:** The flowers are planted by the gardener.

When Do We Use the Passive Voice?

1. When the agent (the person who does the action) is unknown, unimportant, or obvious from the context.

- **Example:** A wallet was found in the cafeteria. (We don't know who found it – unknown agent.)
- **Example:** The road is closed during winter. (By authorities – obvious agent.)

2. When we are more interested in the action than the person who carries it out.

- Often used in news reports, formal notices, instructions, processes, headlines, advertisements, etc.
- **Example:** The law was passed unanimously. (News report.)
- **Example:** Dinner is served until 9 PM. (Formal notice.)

3. To make statements more formal or polite.

- **Example:** The appointment has been cancelled. (More polite than saying, "You cancelled the appointment.")

4. To put emphasis on the agent.

- **Example:** The novel was written by J.K. Rowling.

Compare active and passive:

- **Somebody built** this house in 1981. (active)
- **This house was built** in 1981. (passive)

➤ When we use an **active** verb, we say **what the subject does**:

- **My grandfather was a builder. He built** this house in 1981.
- **It's a big company. It employs** two hundred people.

➤ When we use a **passive** verb, we say **what happens to the subject**:

- 'When **was the house built?**'

'**This house was built** in 1981.'

- **Two hundred people are employed** by the company.

Compare active and passive, present simple, past simple and future simple

Present simple

- Somebody **cleans** this room every day.
- This room **is cleaned** every day.

Active: clean(s)

Passive: is/ am/ are + cleaned

Examples:

1. Active: Careless drivers cause many accidents.

Passive: Many accidents are caused by careless driving.

2. Active: They don't invite me to parties very often.

Passive: I'm not invited to parties very often.

3. Active: How do people pronounce this word?

Passive: How is this word pronounced?

4. Active: The chef prepares delicious meals every day.

Passive: Delicious meals are prepared every day by the chef.

5. Active: People don't speak Spanish in many countries.

Passive: Spanish is not spoken in many countries.

6. Active: Do they cook Chinese food?

Passive: Is Chinese food cooked by them?

Past Simple

Active: cleaned

Passive: was/were + cleaned

Examples:

1. Active: Somebody cleaned this room yesterday.

Passive: This room was cleaned yesterday.

2. Active: The storm damaged many houses.

Passive: Many houses were damaged by the storm.

3. Active: They didn't invite me to the wedding.

Passive: I wasn't invited to the wedding.

4. Active: How did they solve the problem?

Passive: How was the problem solved?

5. Active: The students completed their assignments on time.

Passive: The assignments were completed on time by the students.

6. Active: Did someone call the doctor?

Passive: Was the doctor called by someone?

Future Simple

Active: will clean

Passive: will be + cleaned

Examples:

1. Active: Somebody will clean this room tomorrow.

Passive: This room will be cleaned tomorrow.

2. Active: The company will announce the results next week.

Passive: The results will be announced next week by the company.

3. Active: They won't deliver the package today.

Passive: The package won't be delivered today.

4. Active: When will they complete the project?

Passive: When will the project be completed?

5. Active: The teacher will check the homework later.

Passive: The homework will be checked later by the teacher.

6. Active: Will someone organize the event?

Passive: Will the event be organized by someone?

Exercise: 1

Complete the sentences. Use these verbs in the correct form, present simple or past simple:

cause damage find hold injure invite make
overtake own send show surround

1. Many accidents _____ by careless driving.

2. Cheese _____ from milk.

3. The roof of the building _____ in a storm a few days ago.

4. A cinema is a place where films _____.
5. You _____ to the party. Why didn't you go?
6. This plant is very rare. It _____ in very few places.
7. Although we were driving fast, we _____ by a lot of other cars.
8. In the US, elections for president _____ every four years.
9. There was an accident last night, but fortunately nobody _____.
10. You can't see the house from the road. It _____ by trees.
11. I never received the letter. It _____ to the wrong address.
12. The company I work for _____ by a much larger company.

Exercise: 2

Write questions using the passive. Some are present and some are past.

1. Ask about glass. (how / make?)

How is glass made?

2. Ask about television. (when / invent?)

When _____

3. Ask about mountains. (how / form?)

4. Ask about DNA. (when / discover?)

5. Ask about silver. (what / use for?)

Exercise: 3

Put the verb into the correct form, present or past, active or passive.

1. **a.** Two hundred people _____ (employ) by the company.
b. The company _____ (employ) 200 people.
2. **a.** Water _____ (cover) most of the earth's surface.
b. How much of the earth's surface _____ (cover) by water?

3. a. While I was on holiday, my camera _____ (steal) from my hotel room.
b. While I was on holiday, my camera _____ (disappear) from my hotel room.
4. a. Zain's parents _____ (die) when he was very young.
b. Zain and his sister _____ (bring up) by their grandparents.
5. a. The boat hit a rock and _____ (sink) quickly.
b. Fortunately, everybody _____ (rescue).
6. a. Bill _____ (fire) from his job. He wasn't very good at it.
b. Sofia _____ (resign) from her job because she didn't enjoy it any more.
7. a. It can be noisy living here, but it _____ (not / bother) me.
b. It can be noisy living here, but I _____ (not / bother) by it.
8. a. Maria had an accident. She _____ (knock) off her bike.
b. Maria had an accident. She _____ (fall) off her bike.
9. a. I haven't seen these flowers before. What _____ (they / call)?
b. I haven't seen these flowers before. What _____ (you / call) them?

Exercise: 4

Convert the following sentences from active voice to passive voice while maintaining the correct tense.

1. The gardener waters the plants every morning.
2. They don't sell fresh vegetables in this shop.
3. Does your father repair cars?
4. The teacher explains the lesson clearly.
5. People use this road frequently.
6. Do they play football in this park?
7. She wrote a beautiful poem last night.

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8. They didn't build the bridge in time.
 9. Did the police catch the thief?
 10. He painted the house two weeks ago.
 11. The children broke the vase accidentally.
 12. Did someone deliver the package yesterday?
 13. The team will complete the project next week.
 14. They won't invite him to the party.
 15. Will she bake a cake for the celebration?
 16. Scientists will discover new planets in the future.
 17. He won't write a book this year.
 18. Will the government implement the new policy?
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18 PASSIVE 2 (BEING DONE/ BEEN DONE)

Present Continuous

Active: is/are/am + cleaning

Passive: is/are/am + being + cleaned

Examples:

1. **Active:** Somebody is cleaning this room.

Passive: This room is being cleaned.

2. **Active:** They are not delivering the packages.

Passive: The packages are not being delivered.

3. **Active:** Is the teacher explaining the topic?

Passive: Is the topic being explained by the teacher?

4. **Active:** She is preparing the presentation.

Passive: The presentation is being prepared by her.

5. **Active:** I am fixing the computer.

Passive: The computer is being fixed by me.

6. **Active:** I am not writing the essay.

Passive: The essay is not being written by me.

Exercise: 1

Convert the following sentences into passive voice:

1. They are solving the problem.
2. She is not washing the dishes.
3. Is he reading the book?
4. I am sending an email.
5. Are they painting the fence?

Past Continuous

Active: was/were + cleaning

Passive: was/were + being + cleaned

Examples:

1. Active: Somebody was cleaning this room.

Passive: This room was being cleaned.

2. Active: They were not delivering the packages.

Passive: The packages were not being delivered.

3. Active: Was the teacher explaining the topic?

Passive: Was the topic being explained by the teacher?

4. Active: She was preparing the presentation.

Passive: The presentation was being prepared by her.

5. Active: The workers were fixing the machine.

Passive: The machine was being fixed by the workers.

6. Active: They were not painting the walls.

Passive: The walls were not being painted by them.

Exercise: 2

Convert the following sentences into passive voice:

1. The chef was cooking a delicious meal.
2. She wasn't answering the phone.
3. Were they organizing the files?
4. I was writing a letter.
5. Were the kids playing the piano?

Present Perfect

Active: has/have + cleaned

Passive: has/have + been + cleaned

Examples:

1. **Active:** Somebody has cleaned this room.

Passive: This room has been cleaned.

2. **Active:** They haven't delivered the packages.

Passive: The packages haven't been delivered.

3. **Active:** Has the teacher explained the topic?

Passive: Has the topic been explained by the teacher?

4. **Active:** She has prepared the presentation.

Passive: The presentation has been prepared by her.

5. **Active:** The workers have fixed the machine.

Passive: The machine has been fixed by the workers.

6. **Active:** I haven't finished the essay yet.

Passive: The essay hasn't been finished by me yet.

Exercise: 3

Convert the following sentences into passive voice:

1. She has written a story.

2. They haven't invited me to the party.

3. Has he painted the house?

4. I have sent an email.

5. Have they completed the project?

Past Perfect

Active: had + cleaned

Passive: had + been + cleaned

Examples:

1. **Active:** Somebody had cleaned this room before I arrived.

Passive: This room had been cleaned before I arrived.

2. **Active:** They hadn't delivered the packages by noon.

Passive: The packages hadn't been delivered by noon.

3. **Active:** Had the teacher explained the topic?

Passive: Had the topic been explained by the teacher?

4. Active: She had prepared the presentation before the meeting.

Passive: The presentation had been prepared before the meeting by her.

5. Active: The workers had fixed the machine before it was used.

Passive: The machine had been fixed before it was used by the workers.

6. Active: They hadn't painted the walls yet.

Passive: The walls hadn't been painted yet by them.

Exercise: 4

Convert the following sentences into passive voice:

1. She had finished the report before the deadline.

2. They hadn't repaired the car before the trip.

3. Had the students completed the assignments?

4. He had cleaned the room before the guests arrived.

5. They had already signed the contract.

Future Perfect

Active: will have + cleaned

Passive: will have + been + cleaned

Examples:

1. **Active:** Somebody will have cleaned this room by tomorrow.

Passive: This room will have been cleaned by tomorrow.

2. **Active:** They won't have delivered the packages by noon.

Passive: The packages won't have been delivered by noon.

3. **Active:** Will the teacher have explained the topic by then?

Passive: Will the topic have been explained by the teacher by then?

4. **Active:** She will have prepared the presentation before the meeting.

Passive: The presentation will have been prepared by her before the meeting.

5. **Active:** The workers will have fixed the machine before the inspection.

Passive: The machine will have been fixed before the inspection by the workers.

6. **Active:** I won't have finished the essay by the evening.

Passive: The essay won't have been finished by me by the evening.

Exercise: 5

Convert the following sentences into passive voice:

1. They will have completed the project by next week.
2. She won't have sent the invitation by tomorrow.
3. Will they have painted the house by then?
4. He will have written the book by the end of the year.
5. They will have solved the problem by the deadline.

Exercise: 6

Change into passive.

1. They are repairing the bridge at the moment.
2. We have built a new road around the city.
3. Someone has recorded the meeting.
4. Have they solved the problem?

Exercise: 7

Change the passive into past continuous.

1. Our conversation has been recorded by somebody.
2. The road had been repaired when the accident happened.
3. The windows were not cleaned on Tuesday.
4. The letter had been read when I arrived.

Exercise: 8

Change the voice.

1. My ring was stolen yesterday.
2. They are building two new hotels near the airport.
3. Their team easily won the match.
4. My stolen car has not been recovered by the police.
5. Somebody took my umbrella.
6. He has not seen a neighbour since six months.
7. They completed the project before the deadline.
8. The thief had stolen all the jewellery before police arrived.
9. The car had not been repaired by the time we needed it.
10. The road will have been completed by next year.
11. They will not have finished the project by tomorrow.
12. Will they solve the issue before the deadline?
13. The teacher will have checked all the papers by next week.
14. The book will be completed by him.
15. They will publish the results in May.
16. The teacher is scolding Ali for not doing homework.
17. My mother is being helped by my sister.
18. The administration has distributed new forms for admissions.
19. He studied chemistry in the Government College Lahore.
20. Bilal hates cricket as he is interested in football.

Structure:

- **Active:** Modal + base verb
- **Passive:** Modal + be + past participle

Examples with All Modal Verbs:**1. Can**

Active: They can solve the problem.

Passive: The problem can be solved.

2. Could

Active: She could finish the work today.

Passive: The work could be finished today.

3. May

Active: Someone may take the documents.

Passive: The documents may be taken.

4. Might

Active: They might announce the results tomorrow.

Passive: The results might be announced tomorrow.

5. Must

Active: You must submit the assignment by Monday.

Passive: The assignment must be submitted by Monday.

6. Should

Active: They should follow the rules.

Passive: The rules should be followed.

7. Would

Active: He would deliver the message.

Passive: The message would be delivered.

Exercise: 1

Make sentences using the given modal verbs in active/passive:

1. (You / can / finish / the report / today)
2. (She / could / clean / the room / this afternoon)
3. (They / may / announce / the winner / tomorrow)
4. (The thief / might / steal / the painting)
5. (We / must / protect / the environment)
6. (He / should / return / the books / on time)
7. (The courier / would / deliver / the package / soon)
8. (Can / they / solve / the problem?)
9. (Should / she / follow / the guidelines?)
10. (The manager / must / approve / the budget)
11. (Might / someone / break / the window?)
12. (Could / he / explain / the situation / clearly?)
13. (You / should / lock / the doors / before leaving)
14. (They / may / start / the project / next week)
15. (Would / you / sign / the agreement / today?)

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PASSIVE 4 (BELIEFS AND REPORTS, AND VERBS WITH TWO OBJECTS)

1. Beliefs and Reports

Certain verbs like 'believe', 'expect', 'know', 'say', 'think', etc., are used to convey beliefs or reports. These can be structured in two ways:

- **Personal construction:** The subject believed to perform the action is mentioned directly.
- **Impersonal construction:** The belief or report is made general or impersonal, often starting with "It is believed that..."

Examples:

- **Active:** The community suspects he is innocent.
- **Passive 1 (Personal):** He is suspected to be innocent.
- **Passive 2 (Impersonal):** It is suspected that he is innocent.

Exercise: 1

Write both personal and impersonal passive sentences for the following:

1. Everyone thinks the play is fantastic.
2. People say that the company is launching a new product.
3. Critics believe the book will be a bestseller.

2. Verbs with Two Objects

Some verbs can take two objects; one usually a person and the other a thing. These verbs include 'give', 'send', 'show', 'tell', 'offer', etc. When transforming such sentences to passive voice, two forms can be made:

- **Passive with person as subject:** More usual, emphasizes the person receiving the action.
- **Passive with object as subject:** Less usual, emphasizes the thing given or shown.

Examples:

- **Active:** The teacher taught the students a new concept.
- **Passive 1 (Person):** The students were taught a new concept.
- **Passive 2 (Object):** A new concept was taught to the students.

Exercise: 2

Transform the following active sentences into two passive forms (starting with the person and the object):

1. The company offered the client a deal.
2. The guide showed the tourists the palace.
3. The coach gave the player some advice.

Exercise: 3

Convert the following active sentences into passive voice:

1. The chef prepares the meal.
2. The teacher corrected the tests.
3. The officer caught the thief.
4. The artist painted a new mural.
5. The mechanic fixed the car.
6. The gardener waters the plants.

Exercise: 4

Write two passive sentences for the following statements:

1. Fans expect the team will win the championship.
2. Researchers know the treatment can be effective.
3. The public suspects the politician is dishonest.
4. The author sent the publisher a manuscript.
5. The manager awarded the employee of the month a prize.
6. The teacher taught the class a new song.
7. People say the police officer is involved in robbery.
8. My brother has bought me a gift.
9. The public believed that the budget would increase inflation.
10. The principal presented a shield to the chief guest.

Exercise: 6

Read the following dialogue between two students planning a school project. Rewrite their conversation using passive voice where appropriate, focusing on highlighting the action rather than the doer.

Context: Ali and Sara are discussing their responsibilities for a group project on environmental conservation.

Dialogue:

1. **Ali:** Sara, I will gather the materials for the poster.
2. **Sarah:** Okay, and I will compile the research data tonight.
3. **Ali:** Great! Mr. Khan will check our progress tomorrow.
4. **Sarah:** Do you know who designed the project guidelines?
5. **Ali:** The science department organized the entire outline.
6. **Sarah:** After we finish, we should display the poster in the hallway.
7. **Ali:** Yes, and someone needs to present our findings at the assembly.

Transformed Dialogue:

1. Ali: Sarah,

2. Sarah: Okay, and

3. Ali: Great!

4. Sarah: Do you know

5. Ali: _____

6. Sarah: After we finish,

7. Ali: Yes, and our findings need to be presented at the assembly by someone.